

Today's Slides and Bonus Resources

The Six Types of Working Genius

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What type of work energizes
you?

Two Undeniable Truths

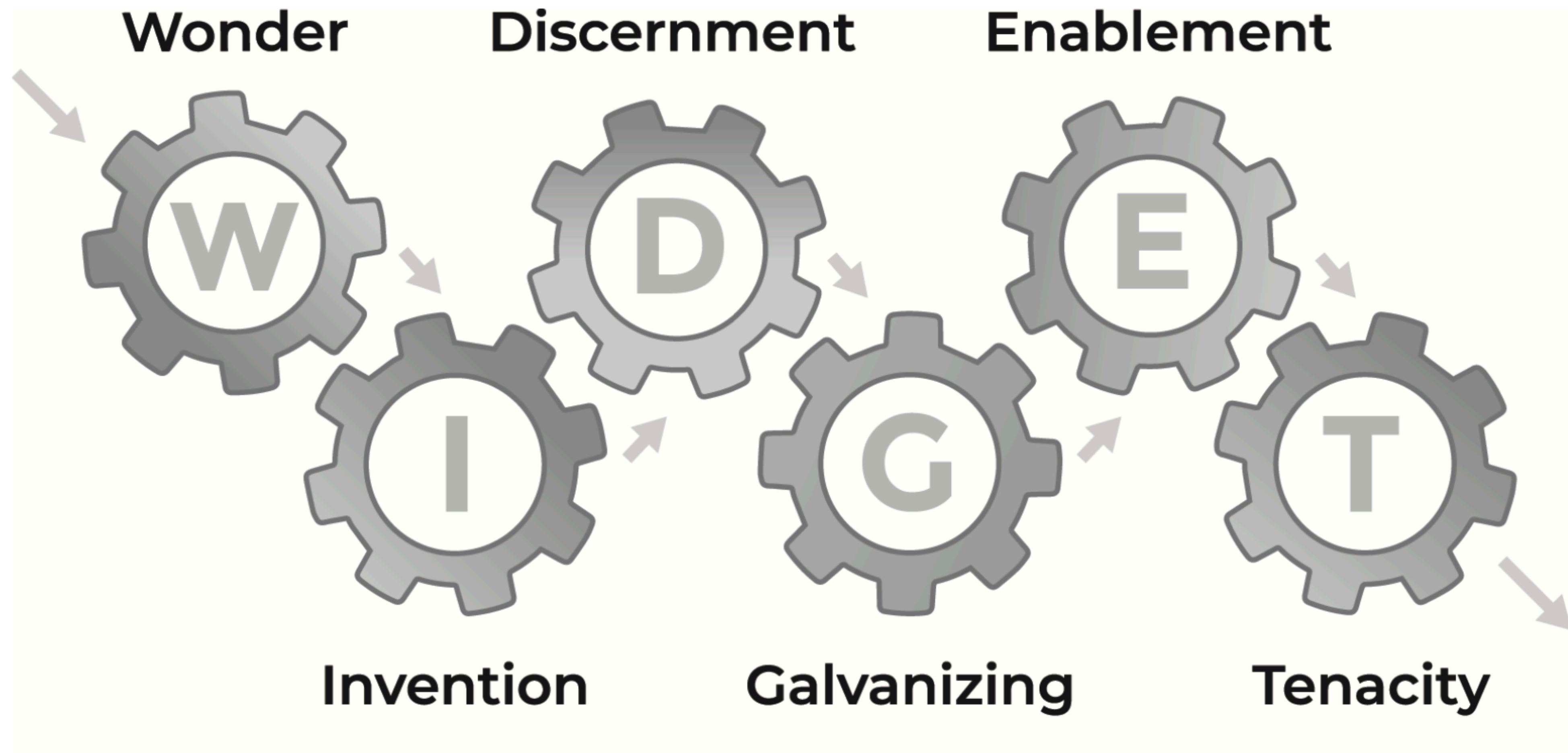
- People who utilize their natural talents are much more fulfilled and successful than those who don't.
- Teams and organizations that help people tap into their natural talents are more productive and successful than those who don't.

What is Working Genius?

- Working Genius is part productivity tool and part personality assessment.
 - It helps you understand what types of work you find most fulfilling (and most draining).
 - It helps us better understand how work gets done.
- Each person has two geniuses, two competencies, and two frustrations.

Defining Key Terms

- **Geniuses.** Areas of work you find most energizing and fulfilling. Often, these reflect natural giftedness.
- **Competencies.** Areas where you are capable and don't mind working sometimes.
- **Frustrations.** Areas when you don't derive energy and probably aren't naturally gifted.



Self-Assessment

- As we talk about each genius, give yourself a rating on a scale of one to ten based on how well you feel the genius describes you.
 - 1 - “This genius doesn’t describe me at all”
 - 10 - “This genius describes me perfectly”
- We’ll use your ratings at the end to build your Working Genius profile.

The Genius of Wonder

- The genius of wonder involves pondering the possibility of greater potential or opportunity.
- People with the genius of wonder love to question assumptions, challenge the status quo, and consider why things are the way they are.
- **Almost every new initiative, program, or project begins because someone wonders.**

People with Wonder

- Things they may say:
 - “Why do we do it this way?”
 - “Can we do it better?”
 - “Maybe we should think about this more.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “He’s never quite satisfied with how things are.”
 - “She’s always asking ‘why’ or ‘why not’.

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave consideration.** They want time and space to ask big questions and for others to validate and join them in their thinking.
- **They are crushed by being dismissed.** They don't like hearing phrases such as "who cares?" or "we don't have time to stop and think about that."

The Genius of Invention

- The genius of invention involves creating original ideas and solutions - often with little or no direction.
- People with the genius of invention are typically confident and energized when faced with problems with no apparent solution.
- This genius is often the easiest one to recognize and appreciate.

People with Invention

- Things they may say:
 - “Hey, I’ve got an idea.”
 - “Here’s something that might work.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “He’s so creative.”
 - “She’s always got a solution, even if we didn’t ask for one.”
 - “Where does he get all these ideas?”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave freedom.** They want to paint on a blank canvas and think outside the box.
- **They are crushed by constraints and premature judgment.** They want their ideas to be heard and valued, even if it's not quite time to move forward.

The Genius of Discernment

- The genius of discernment involves using instinct or intuition to assess and evaluate ideas.
- People with discernment enjoy considering whether ideas should be acted upon or if they need to be adjusted.
- Discernment helps people avoid going too far with ideas that aren't ready yet.

People with Discernment

- Things they may say:
 - “Now that is a great idea!”
 - “I don’t think this is going to work.”
 - “Here’s what might need to change.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “He’s always got the best advice. Ask him.”
 - “I would trust her gut. She has strong intuition.”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave trust.** They want people to validate their judgments, instincts, and assessments - even if there's still discussion about how to proceed.
- **They are crushed by skepticism.** They don't like being asked to "prove" what their gut or intuition is telling them.

The Genius of Galvanizing

- The genius of galvanizing involves rallying people around an idea and inspiring them to take action.
- People with the genius of galvanizing don't mind persuading others to think differently or change their plans.
- Galvanizing is necessary so that people will commit (and recommit) to moving forward.

People with Galvanizing

- Things they may say:
 - “Is everyone on board with this?”
 - “Come on! This is a huge opportunity.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “She has so much energy and passion for what we’re doing.”
 - “You can always count on him to get us going.”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave reaction.** They want others to hear their galvanizing and affirm that what they are advocating for is real and worthwhile.
- **They are crushed by apathy.** They can feel disengaged or frustrated when nobody responds to their galvanizing or when they are ignored.

The Genius of Enablement

- The genius of enablement involves answering the call to action and providing support, encouragement, and assistance.
- Enablement is one of the hardest geniuses to define or understand - many people with this genius don't see it as a gift.
- However, people with enablement can be some of the best team players.

Important Notes about Enablement

- **Enablement is NOT the only genius that involves helping others.** All six geniuses can be helpful.
- **Remember, your geniuses are where you find energy and joy.** People with the genius of enablement find fulfillment from providing support and assistance on ideas and projects that didn't originate with them.

People with Enablement

- Things they may say:
 - “Let me know how I can help with this.”
 - “I want this to be successful. What do you need?”
- Things others say about them:
 - “Whenever I need help, he’s the first person I can count on.”
 - “She’s the best team player we have.”

Craves and Crushes

- **They crave genuine requests for help and appreciation for the role they played.** They don't have to be acknowledged on stage, but they want to hear that they are helping and making a difference.
- **They are crushed by being overlooked.** They don't want to be taken for granted or have their contributions go without being acknowledged.

The Genius of Tenacity

- The genius of tenacity involves pushing projects and tasks through to completion.
- People with tenacity love getting things done, crossing items off a list, and knowing that they met the standards for completion.
- You can count on somebody with the genius of tenacity to meet goals and complete projects even when challenges arise.

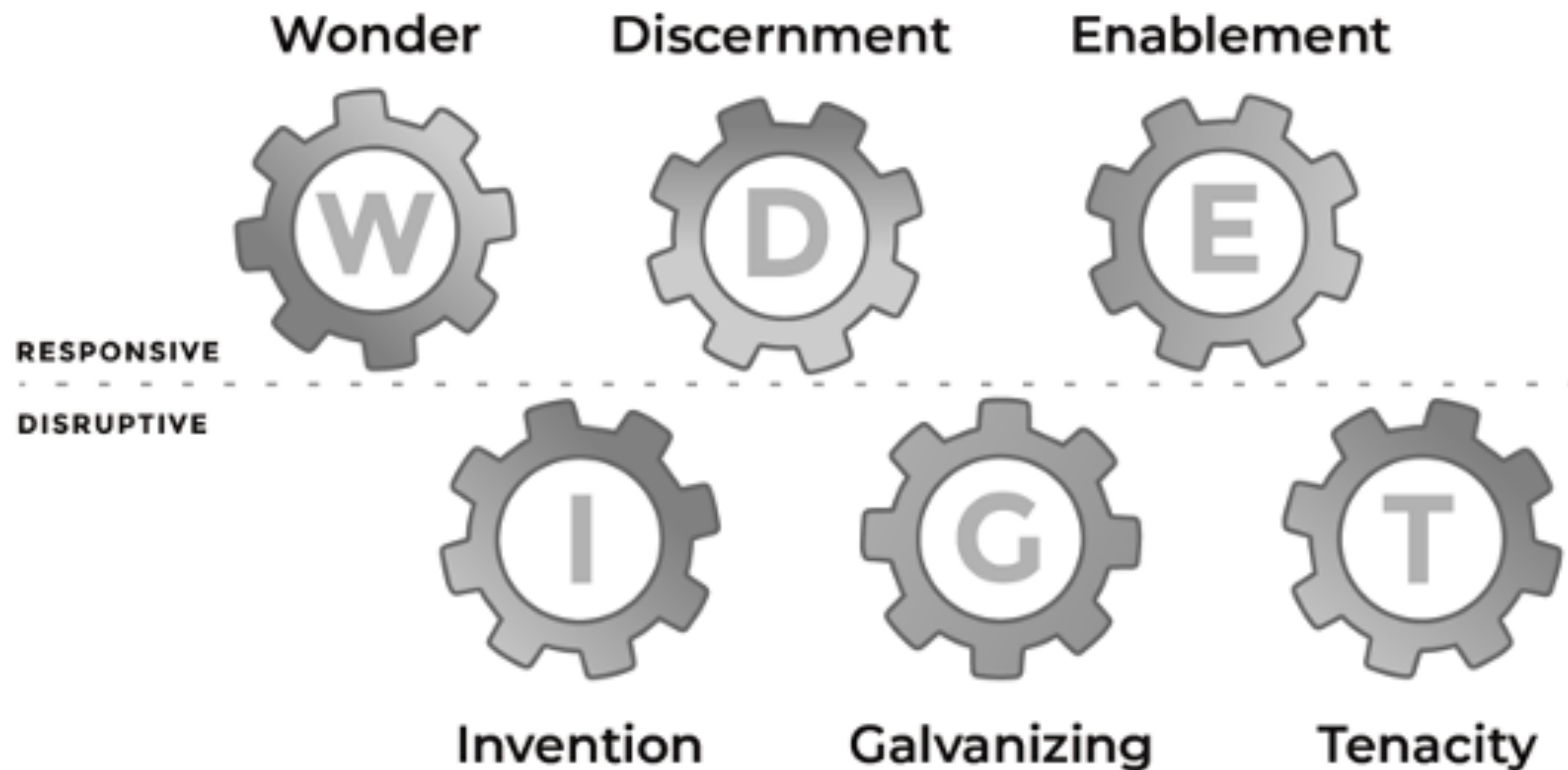
People with Tenacity

- Things they may say:
 - “Here, let me do it.”
 - “I’m worried we won’t meet our deadline.”
- Things others say about them:
 - “I don’t think she’s ever missed a deadline.”
 - “He’s going to do whatever it takes to get it done.”

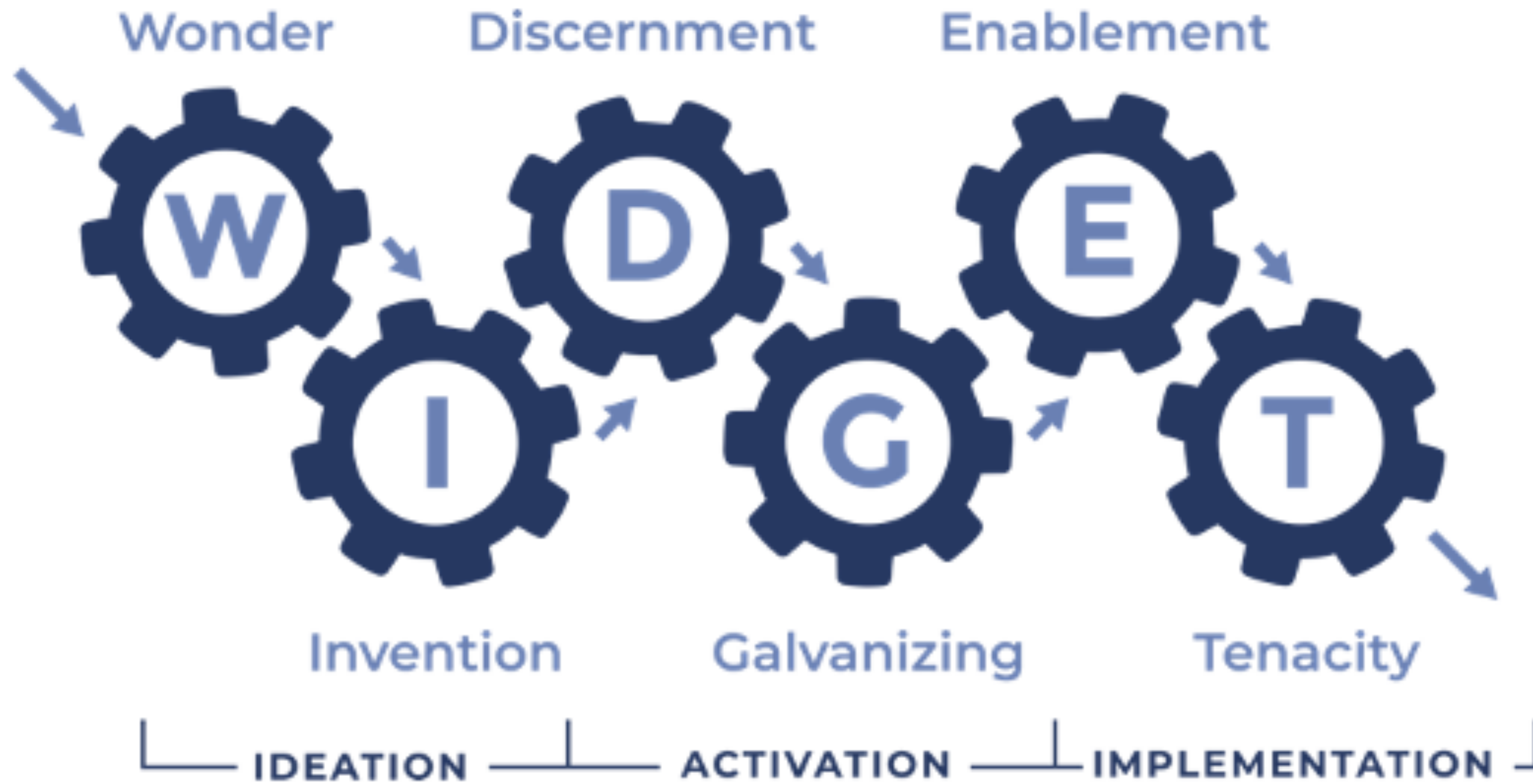
Craves and Crushes

- **They crave clarity.** They want to know exactly what steps are necessary for work to be considered “done.”
- **They are crushed by ambiguity or moving targets.** When they think they are working toward one goal and it changes unexpectedly, it can be frustrating.

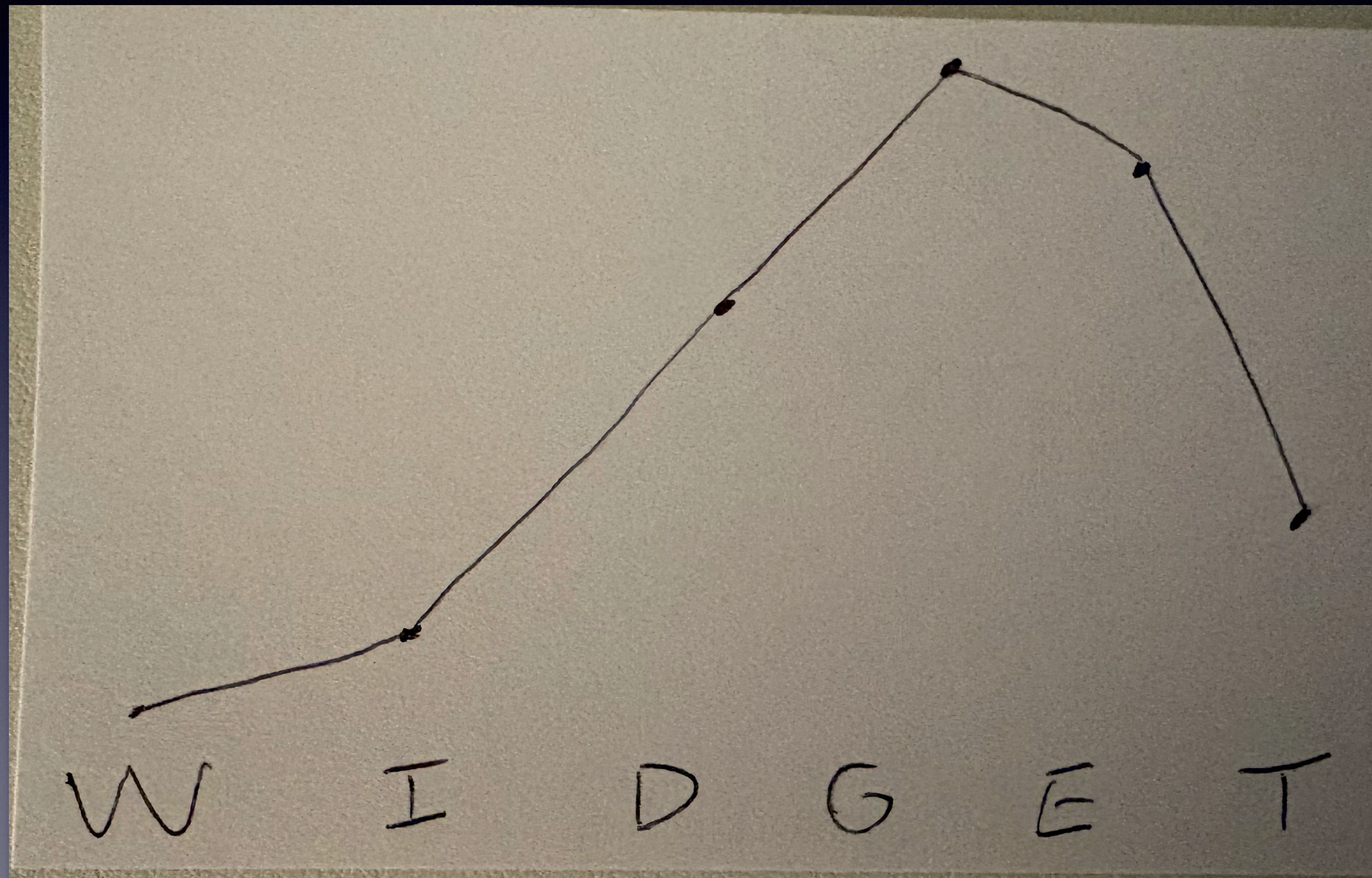
Responsive and Disruptive Geniuses



Three Stages of Work



Energy Mapping



Individual Results

- Look back at your ratings and put your geniuses in order from highest to lowest.
 - Top two: Working Geniuses (likely 8-10)
 - Middle two: Working Competencies (likely 5-7)
 - Bottom two: Working Frustrations (likely below 5)
- Pay attention to whether you lean more responsive or disruptive and how you're balanced across the three stages of work.

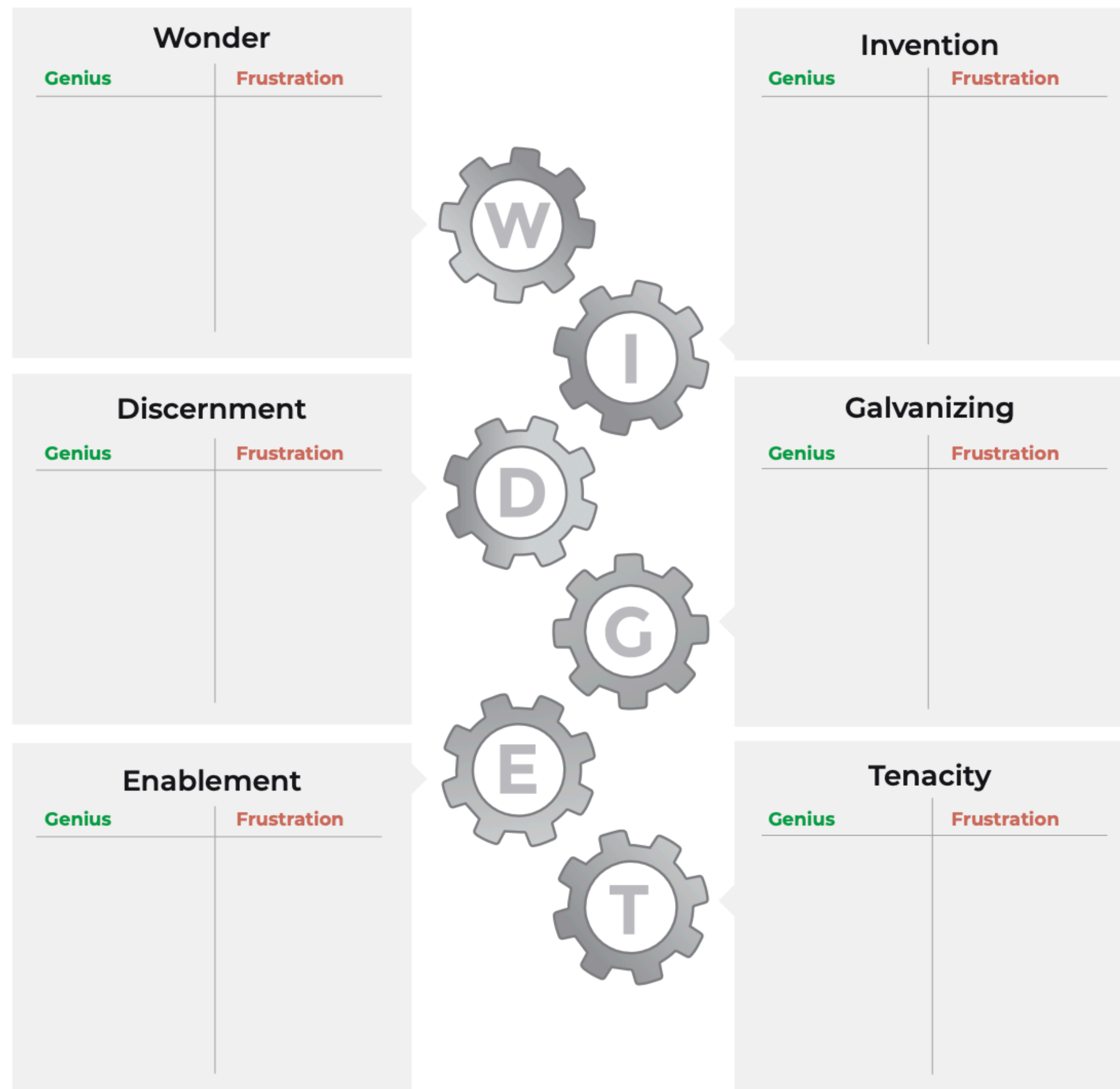
Individual Results

- **We're going to take turns sharing our Working Genius profiles.**
- In addition to telling us your geniuses, competencies, and frustrations, feel free to share anything else about your results/assessment that resonated with you.

Individual Applications

- Work in your areas of genius as often as possible.
- Be honest about your frustrations without guilt.
- Use people and systems to compensate for your frustrations.
- Consider your geniuses and frustrations when planning your schedule.
- Acknowledge and appreciate the unique contributions of others.

Team Applications



Team Applications

- Allow people to operate in their areas of genius as much as possible.
- Don't be afraid to reconsider/reassign traditional responsibilities based on individual geniuses.
- Remember that each person brings value, regardless of what their geniuses are.

More Team Applications

- Implement the language into conversations.
 - Example #1: “I haven’t discerned this idea yet.”
 - Example #2: “I’d love to bring you into this project for your enablement and tenacity.”
- Define what you need at specific points of work.
 - Example #1: “I don’t think we’ve wondered enough yet.”
 - Example #2: “We’ve moved past ideation. It’s time for activation.”

Even More Team Applications

- Don't over-rely on competencies.
- Use your team map to make meetings and projects better.
- Give everyone a chance to exercise their geniuses.

Additional Resources

- “The Six Types of Working Genius” book by Patrick Lencioni
- “The Six Times of Working Genius” podcast (usually releases new episodes on Wednesday)
- “The Six Types of Working Genius” website and resources